

“Our approach now is Invest India 2.0”

Invest India MD & CEO Nivruti Rai says along with investments, she is also working on enhancing trade and technology at the national investment promotion and facilitation agency

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Invest India acts as a point of reference for potential investors and facilitates investments for initiatives such as Make in India and Startup India. Set up in 2009 as a non-profit venture under the then Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion, it provides end-to-end support and is a one-stop solution for both domestic and foreign investors. Acting as a bridge between investors and the government, 51% of Invest India's shares are held by industry associations (17% each by Ficci, CII and Nasscom) and the remaining 49% is with the Centre and state governments. It has facilitated projects such as an apparel manufacturing facility by Singapore's Ramatex in Tamil Nadu and a copper tube manufacturing facility by Malaysia's Mettube in Gujarat. In fact, over the last fiscal alone, Invest India has

facilitated the entry of investors with plans to invest upwards of \$1.27 billion.

Nivruti Rai, MD & CEO of Invest India, knows how India Inc. works and what investors want. Rai, 56, worked for 29 years at Intel, of which she spent seven years as Intel India Country Head. It has been a year for Rai at the helm at Invest India and she has used that time to understand how investors view India, and she has taken measures to address their concerns.

In an interview with *Business Today's Surabhi*, she speaks about the PLI scheme and why it's important to boost manufacturing, India's semiconductor manufacturing plans, and the future of AI. Edited excerpts:

Q: It has been a year since you took over. How has the journey been? What are your priorities?

A: I call the journey that we are on Invest India 2.0. My assumption is that Invest India 1.0 was very successful in terms of marketing India. Our approach now is Invest India 2.0. I was told to run Invest India like I ran my previous company. We have a vision for the next few years, and we have six focus sectors, which we call PM 6 or Priority Mandate Six. Each of these six sectors has many sub-sectors. **These six sectors are: electronics and semiconductors, automotive and EVs, renewable energy (with a focus on solar and green hydrogen), agro and food processing, textiles, and pharma and healthcare, where we are focussing on biologics and biosimilars.** And infrastructure—physical and